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THE CALLING CARD

Build a faith-informed brand voice that connects, converts, and stays true to who you are.

BY MK PARRISH · \$35

START HERE

You can usually feel it in the first sentence.

Some faith brands sound like a greeting card wrote them. Some sound like a sales bro borrowed a Bible verse to close a deal. And a rare few sound like a *person* — a specific, real, slightly unpredictable human you'd actually want to hear from. That last category is the one that builds something. The voice is the brand.

Here's what most people get wrong: they think brand voice is a vibe, a feeling, an "it" you either have or don't. It isn't. Voice is a set of *decisions* — about words, rhythm, posture, and the specific overlap between how you talk and how your people talk. Decisions can be made on purpose. Which means a voice that connects and converts can be *built*, deliberately, from scratch.

That's what this book does. We'll build your faith-informed voice from the ground up, map the exact language your audience already uses, calibrate it for each platform without fracturing it, and then I'll walk you through one complete annotated example so you can see every gear turning.

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*Your voice isn't decoration on the brand. It **is** the brand. Everything else is logistics.*

Let's build the thing people recognize before they see your name.

CHAPTER ONE: THE FOUR DIALS

A brand voice isn't one setting. It's four dials, each on a spectrum. Set them on purpose and you have a voice. Leave them to chance and you have noise.

Dial One — Formality. From buttoned-up to barefoot. Faith brands often default to formal because they confuse formality with reverence. They're not the same. You can be deeply reverent in plain, casual language — often *more* so, because it's honest. Decide where you actually sit. *(This book's voice: low formality, high conviction.)*

Dial Two — Warmth vs. Edge. From a warm hand on the shoulder to a sharp elbow in the ribs. Pure warmth gets ignored as wallpaper; pure edge exhausts people. The strongest faith voices run warm *with* edge — kind enough to trust, sharp enough to remember. Decide your ratio.

Dial Three — Authority vs. Intimacy. From "I'm the teacher" to "I'm in this with you." You can lead from a stage or from the next seat over. Faith audiences burned by gatekeeping respond to intimacy; audiences seeking expertise want some authority. Most durable voices blend: *authoritative about the method, intimate about the struggle.*

Dial Four — Density. From spare and punchy to lush and layered. Short sentences hit. Long ones breathe and build. The trick isn't picking one — it's the *rhythm* between them. (Notice this paragraph just did it.)

Write your four settings down as a single line: *"Casual, warm-with-edge, authority-on-method / intimacy-on-struggle, punchy-with-occasional-breath."* That line is your voice spec. Everything you write gets checked against it.

CHAPTER TWO: THE VOICE PILLARS

Dials set the *sound*. Pillars set the *substance* — the recurring moves that make your voice yours and not a competitor's with the same dials.

Build three to five pillars. Each is a short rule plus a why.

Example pillars (this brand's):

- **No churchy guilt.** *We never motivate through shame. Why: shame is the wound our people are recovering from.*
- **Name the real thing.** *We say the actual struggle out loud — the skipped days, the underpricing, the fear. Why: being seen beats being inspired.*
- **Method over mood.** *We give tools you can use, not feelings you'll forget. Why: our people have been inspired plenty; they're starved for something that works.*
- **Faith without the costume.** *We talk about belief like adults, not in a special holy register. Why: the fake-reverent voice is exactly what made faith feel inaccessible.*

Pillars do two jobs. They keep *you* consistent across a year of content, and they keep anyone writing on your behalf — a VA, a contractor, future-you at 11pm — sounding like you. When you're unsure whether something is on-brand, you don't ask "does this feel right?" You ask "does this obey the pillars?" That's the difference between a vibe and a system.

CHAPTER THREE: AUDIENCE LANGUAGE MAPPING

Here's the move that separates a voice that *connects* from one that just *exists*: you build it partly out of your audience's own words. Not to manipulate — to be understood. People trust the brand that sounds like the voice already inside their own head.

This is fieldwork, not invention. Gather the raw language:

Where to mine:

- The comments on your posts and on creators your audience also follows.
- Reviews — yours and competitors'. One- and five-star reviews are language gold; people get specific when they're thrilled or furious.
- DMs and emails your audience sends you. Copy the exact phrases.
- Threads, subreddits, and groups where your people talk to *each other* (not to brands). This is the most honest source.

What to capture, in four buckets:

1. **Pain phrases** — how they describe the problem. *"I always feel behind." "I quit somewhere in Leviticus." "I don't want to feel guilty about it."* Use these verbatim in your hooks.
2. **Desire phrases** — how they describe what they want. *"Something that actually fits my brain." "I want it to stick this time." "Without it being weird."*
3. **Objection phrases** — the doubt that stops them. *"I'm not a Bible person." "I don't have time." "Is this going to be preachy?"* Answer these in your copy before they're asked.

4. **Forbidden words** — the church/marketing jargon that makes them flinch. Build a *kill list* and never use those words. (For a skeptic-friendly faith audience: "anointed," "do life," "unpack," "lean in," "blessed and highly favored" — flinch words. Cut them.)

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*Don't write **at** your audience in your words. Write **to** them in theirs.*

Keep this map as a living doc. Refresh it quarterly. Your audience's language drifts, and the brands that sound current are the ones still listening.

CHAPTER FOUR: PLATFORM CALIBRATION

A common fear: "If I adapt my voice per platform, won't I lose consistency?" No — *if* you do it right. The substance stays fixed; the delivery flexes. Same person, different rooms. You talk differently at a dinner party than on a panel, but you're still recognizably you.

Lock these as your fixed core (never flex): your pillars, your kill list, your warmth-with-edge ratio. Then calibrate the rest:

Instagram / short-form. Punchier. Lead with the bruise. Shorter sentences, more white space, one idea. Density dial drops; edge can come up a notch because the format rewards a strong opening line.

Email. Most intimate. This is where the Intimacy dial goes highest — write like a letter to one person, not a broadcast. Longer breaths allowed. Your warmest, most personal register lives here.

LinkedIn / professional. Formality dial up slightly, never to stiff. Lead with the insight rather than the confession, but keep the edge — it's what makes you stand out in a feed of beige thought-leadership.

Sales pages. Authority dial up. Still warm, still honest, but here you *lead*. The reader needs confidence to buy, and a too-intimate, too-tentative voice reads as unsure of the offer.

Podcast / video / audio. Closest to how you actually talk — so let contractions, asides, and rhythm run free. The voice on the page should already sound like this; here it just gets to breathe out loud.

The test for healthy calibration: paste a paragraph from each platform side by side with the author's name removed. A stranger should be able to tell all five were written by the same person. If they can't, you've changed the substance, not just the delivery. Pull back to the core.

CHAPTER FIVE: ONE COMPLETE ANNOTATED EXAMPLE

Theory's done. Here's a real piece — a short email opener for a skeptic-friendly faith brand — with every voice decision marked so you can see the machine running.

Subject: you're not behind (you just got bad instructions) ¹

I quit reading the Bible in Leviticus once. ²

Right around the part about which fabrics you're allowed to wear, I closed it and decided studying Scripture wasn't for people like me. ³ *People who didn't grow up knowing this stuff. People who ask too many questions.* ⁴

Turns out the problem was never me. It was the method — I'd opened a 2,000-year-old library in the middle and started reading, then blamed myself for being lost. ⁵

If you've got a graveyard of half-finished reading plans, I want you to hear this: you don't need more discipline. You need a method that doesn't fight you. ⁶

That's the whole reason I built The Study. Five real methods, plain language, no seminary and no shame — \$18, and it's the thing I wish someone had handed me before Leviticus. ⁷

And if not? Go open the book anyway. Start in a Gospel, not Leviticus. That tip's free. ⁸

— MK

The annotations:

1. **Subject line** — uses an audience *pain phrase* ("behind") and a *reframe* in five words. Lowercase = casual Formality dial.
2. **Opens on the bruise, not the bible.** Pillar: *name the real thing.* A confession in the first line.
3. **Specific, slightly funny detail.** Edge dial. "Which fabrics you're allowed to wear" disarms — warmth *with* edge.
4. **Audience objection phrases, verbatim.** "People who ask too many questions" answers the *is-this-for-me* doubt by naming it.
5. **The reframe, stated as method not morality.** Pillar: *method over mood.* Removes shame — pillar: *no churchy guilt.*
6. **Pain phrase ("half-finished reading plans") + the brand's signature line.** Authority-on-method, delivered intimately.
7. **The offer: mission first, price named plainly.** No coyness, no apology. One product, one number, one reason.
8. **The clean exit + free value.** Lets the reader say no and stay. Warmth dial closes it out.

Notice what's *absent*: no "blessed," no "do life," no fake reverence. Every kill-list word stayed dead. That restraint is as much the voice as anything on the page.

WHAT'S NEXT

You came in thinking voice was a vibe you either had or didn't. Now you have a spec — four dials, a set of pillars, your audience's actual words, platform calibration, and a worked example you can reverse-engineer forever.

The Calling Card is part of **Scripture & Strategy** — my line for women building faith-aligned work without the guilt, the gatekeeping, or the seminary bill.

Where to go next:

- **The Study** — the personal practice underneath all of it.
- **Gospel & Grind** — align what you believe with what you sell, and price it cleanly.
- **The Sermon Notes** — turn your study into content this voice can carry.
- **Ministry, Monetized** — launch and grow a paying Bible study community in this voice.

Get all five in the **Scripture & Strategy bundle** and save — the whole system, start to finish.

Want it guided, with live teaching and feedback on your actual voice? The **Scripture & Strategy course** is open now.

Everything lives at mkparrish.com.

The world has enough greeting-card brands and enough sales bros. Go sound like a person.

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